Salvation History Timeline

Rules — Ages 8-12 • 2-6 Players • 25 Minutes

Players	Ages	Time	Difficulty
2–6	**8–12**	**25 min**	**Easy**

> *"Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever." — Hebrews 13:8*

Overview

Salvation History Timeline helps players see the Bible as one story of God's faithfulness — from creation to Pentecost. Place event cards in chronological order on the shared timeline board. Every correct placement earns points; every mistake teaches something new.

Components

- **60 Event Cards** — biblical events with dates, descriptions, and Scripture references
- **1 Timeline Board** — six eras with anchor events already placed

Setup

1. Place the **Timeline Board** in the center of the table.
2. Shuffle all 60 Event Cards face-down.
3. Deal **5 cards** to each player (face-down, no peeking yet).
4. Place the remaining cards in a draw pile face-down.
5. The youngest player goes first.

How to Play

On your turn:

1. **Look** at your hand of cards (don't show other players).
2. **Choose** one Event Card to play.
3. **Place** it face-up on the Timeline Board in the era where you think it belongs. If there are already cards in that era, place yours in the correct order (earlier events to the left, later to the right).
4. **Announce** the event name and era: "The Baptism of Christ — The Incarnation era."
5. **Check** — other players may challenge your placement by saying "Challenge!"

Challenges

- If **no one challenges**, your card stays. Score **2 points**.
- If someone **challenges correctly** (your era or order was wrong), the challenger moves the card to the right position and scores **1 point**. You score **0**.
- If someone **challenges incorrectly** (your placement was actually right), you score **3 points** and the challenger loses **1 point**.
- When in doubt, check the date and Scripture reference printed on the card.

Drawing Cards

After placing a card, draw one from the draw pile (if any remain) to refill your hand. Play passes clockwise.

End of Game

The game ends when all players have played all their cards and the draw pile is empty. The player with the most points wins!

Cooperative Variant

For younger players or Sunday school groups, play as a team! Take turns placing cards together. Discuss where each event goes. The goal is to place all 60 events correctly. No points — just learning together.

Speed Round Variant

Deal all cards evenly. No challenges — just place as quickly as you can. When everyone is done, check the timeline together. Count how many are in the right era and order.

> **Tip for Servants:** After the game, walk through the completed timeline together. Ask: “What patterns do you see? Where do you see God keeping His promises?” The Leader Guide has discussion questions for each era.

Era Guide & Color Key

Each card is color-coded by era to help players learn the periods of salvation history:

Era	Color	Period	Key Theme
Creation & Patriarchs	Green	Beginning – c. 1550 BC	God creates, promises, and chooses a people
Exodus & Conquest	Blue	c. 1550 – 1200 BC	God delivers, provides, and gives the Law
Judges & Kings	Purple	c. 1200 – 930 BC	God raises leaders, establishes the kingdom
Prophets & Exile	Red	c. 930 BC – 5 BC	God warns, disciplines, and promises restoration
The Incarnation	Gold	c. 5 BC – AD 30	God becomes man — life, death, resurrection
The Early Church	Teal	c. AD 30 – AD 100	The Spirit empowers, the Church spreads

Quick Reference: Anchor Events

These events are pre-placed on the board to help orient players:

- **Creation** — God creates heaven and earth
- **The Flood** — Noah and the Ark
- **Abraham Called** — Father of the faithful
- **The Exodus** — God frees Israel from Egypt
- **The Ten Commandments** — The Law given at Sinai
- **Entering the Promised Land** — Joshua leads Israel
- **David's Kingdom** — God promises an eternal throne
- **Solomon's Temple** — God dwells among His people
- **The Kingdom Divides** — North and south
- **Elijah on Carmel** — The Lord alone is God
- **Fall of Jerusalem** — Babylon destroys the Temple
- **Return from Exile** — God restores His people
- **The Nativity** — God becomes man
- **The Crucifixion** — Christ dies for the world
- **The Resurrection** — Christ conquers death
- **Pentecost** — The Holy Spirit descends
- **St. Mark in Egypt** — The Coptic Church is founded
- **The Gospel Spreads** — Apostles carry the faith

Note: The dates on the cards are approximate and follow common biblical chronology. Different traditions may assign slightly different dates to some events.

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